Jackman Wheels Ambassador Program — Design

Owner: Austin Fitzgerald · **Version:** v1 · **Date:** 2026-10-06 · **Status:** Draft for internal review
Companion files: `03 Content and Social/jackman-ambassador-master-priority-2026-10-06-v2.xlsx` (the 59-account roster and scoring) **Governed by:** `jackman-social-playbook-2026-09-14-v1.md` — every rule in Part 1 of that playbook applies here too.

Part 0 — The plan as you described it

Captured verbatim so the rest of this document can be checked against it.

1. Find influential people to work with. The prospect lists support this.
2. Work with people on a **sponsorship** basis — a full year, 2027, reviewed near the end to decide on 2028.
3. Hit local Southern California events and ask ambassadors to **display their vehicle**, roughly one per show.
4. Expect them to **post about us at least once a month**, ideally organically.
5. Expect them to **help push sales and announcements** through their audience.
6. Pricing reviewed individually — **some get wheels, some get a deep discount**.
7. Each gets a **discount code to hand out** to their friends.

Everything below either turns one of those into an operating decision, or flags something the seven points do not yet cover.

Part 1 — The three things that need deciding before anything else

These are not details. Each one changes the shape of the program.

A. The discount codes collide with the dealer channel

This is the most serious issue in the plan and it is not visible from inside point 7.

You have **25 dealers in progress**. A dealer's entire reason to stock you is margin. If fifteen ambassadors are handing out codes that undercut dealer pricing, you are competing with the people you are simultaneously asking to carry inventory — and dealers find out, because their customers show them the code.

Three ways through it, in order of preference:

1. **Keep the code below dealer margin.** A 10–15% friend code sits under typical dealer margin, so a dealer can still beat or match it on service and fitment. Low risk, still feels like a real perk.

2. **Make codes work at dealers too.** Harder to administer, but it turns ambassadors into dealer traffic drivers instead of dealer competitors. Strongest long-term answer.
3. **DTC-only codes, disclosed to dealers up front.** Workable only if the discount is modest and you tell dealers before they hear it from a customer.

Recommendation: option 1 now, option 2 as the 2028 version. **Do not go above 15% without deciding this deliberately. Decision needed from:** Austin, before any ambassador is told what their code will be.

B. "At least once a month" and "push our sales" pull against each other — and against your own playbook

Point 4 wants organic. Point 5 wants promotion. Those are different behaviours, and your own playbook already rules on it:

> *Rule 16 — No sale or promo graphics as feed posts. Promotion goes in Stories, email, and dealer pages.*

So the resolution is already written:

- **The monthly minimum is a feed post or Reel, and it stays organic.** Their truck, their voice, their caption. You never supply copy.
- **Announcements and sales go to Stories, with their code.** Capped, briefed, assets supplied by you.

That satisfies both points without breaking a rule you set for good reasons.

C. You are one person, and fifteen ambassadors is a part-time job

Every ambassador is a monthly content check, a shipping coordination, an event conversation, a code to reconcile and a relationship to maintain. At fifteen people that is a standing commitment competing with everything else in the department.

Recommendation: launch with 8. Six from Wave 1 and two platform fills. Prove the operating rhythm through Q1, then expand to 12–15 in Q2 2027 if it is holding. A program that works at 8 can grow. A program that collapses at 15 cannot be restarted — those people talk to each other.

Part 2 — Tiers, not individual deals

Point 6 says pricing will be reviewed individually. Keep the *judgement* individual, but make the *terms* tiered.

Why this matters specifically for you: your Wave 1 is seven people who largely already follow each other inside one SoCal cluster. They **will** compare deals. Ad-hoc pricing across a group that talks is how a program generates resentment in month three. Tiers are defensible when compared; bespoke deals are not.

	Tier 1 — Founding	Tier 2 — Ambassador	Tier 3 — Seed	Contractor
Who	Delivers assets or events you'd otherwise buy — photographers, event hosts, community owners	The core roster	Under the reach floor, but owns a platform nobody else covers	Paid creative services
Wheels	Full set, free	Deep discount	At or near cost	N/A — separate agreement
Spare	Yes, 5th wheel	Optional at cost	No	N/A
Code	Yes + commission	Yes	Yes	No
Events	1–2 shows, expected	1 show, offered	None	By booking
Posts	1/month + assets delivered	1/month	1/month	Per contract
Headcount	3–4	4–6	3–4	1–2

Contractor is a real and separate thing. @familycruiser250 asked for money and is a product photographer. Do not push him into an ambassador tier and negotiate an influencer fee. Buy a **photography day rate with usage rights** and let the ambassador posting ride inside it. You were going to spend that money on product photography regardless — this way the audience arrives attached to a line item already in the budget. Same logic applies to @ghostpro.la and @yotawolf89 if they quote.

> ***Numbers I cannot set for you:*** *wheel COGS, retail, and the discount percentage behind "deep discount." Give me those three and I will model what each tier costs at 8, 12 and 15 ambassadors. A free set is not free — it is COGS, plus shipping, plus forgone margin, times four or five wheels.*

Part 3 — The deliverable spec

What goes in the agreement, stated plainly enough that nobody has to interpret it.

Monthly minimum — 1 feed post or Reel.

- Stories are encouraged but **do not count** toward the minimum. Say this explicitly or you will receive twelve Stories and no posts.
- You never supply the caption. Brief the subject, not the words.
- Miss two consecutive months and the agreement goes to review. Say that up front; it is much harder to raise later.

Announcements — up to 6 per year, Stories only.

- 7 days' notice minimum, assets supplied by you, their code included.
- Six is deliberately low. A sponsorship that feels like a job gets resented. Under-ask and they will over-deliver.

Content rights — this is the part people forget. Your playbook requires written permission before you use anyone's content, screenshotted and filed in `04 UGC and Permissions`. **Put the grant in the agreement instead**, and you stop chasing permission post by post for a year:

- Perpetual right to reuse their Jackman content in organic social, paid social, email, web and dealer material.
- In-grid reuse is a **Collab**, never a download-and-re-upload. Playbook rule 11.
- Photographer credit and owner handle in the first two lines. Rule 13.
- **Ask for the raw files**, not just the published post. With paid social launching, a high-res original is worth several times a 1080px export.

Disclosure — not optional. Free product or a commissioned code makes these **material connections under FTC rules**. Every post must be disclosed: Instagram's Paid Partnership label, or clear #ad / #sponsored. This is the ambassador's legal obligation and your exposure.

Put it in the agreement, supply a one-line example, and check it on the first post from every ambassador. A revived brand cannot absorb an FTC story any more than it can absorb a wheel-failure story.

Conduct clause. You are tying the brand to an individual for twelve months. Short, plain-language clause: either party can terminate on 30 days' notice; immediate termination for conduct that brings the brand into disrepute. Nobody objects to it, and the one time you need it you will need it badly.

Part 4 — The event program

Point 3 is the strongest part of the plan. It is also the part with real logistics.

The rule: one ambassador vehicle per show. Correct instinct — two rigs reads as a car park, one reads as a feature.

Pick by platform, not by follower count. The ambassador whose truck matches the show's audience is the right one, every time.

What they get — decide this now:

- Fuel or travel stipend? A SoCal drive is different from a two-day haul.

- Entry passes, parking, load-in credentials?
- Who insures a privately owned vehicle sitting on your stand?

None of these are large costs. All of them are awkward discovered on the morning of load-in.

Fitment lead time drives everything. A display vehicle has to be *wearing* Jackman wheels, photographed, and ideally posted about before it stands at a show. **Work back 6–8 weeks from each show date** for fitment confirmation, shipping and install.

2027 calendar — recurring SoCal and regional events. I have not verified 2027 dates; these are the annual fixtures and their usual windows. **Confirm each before building the plan around it.**

Window	Event	Notes
Late Jan / early Feb	King of the Hammers, Johnson Valley	Hardcore off-road audience. Desert build platforms
Spring	Regional Toyota and truck meets, SoCal	Low cost, high cluster relevance. Where your Wave 1 already is
May	Overland Expo West, Flagstaff AZ	Not SoCal, but the category's flagship. Worth one ambassador
Summer	Local trail days and group runs	@keepitdirty_offroad and @zr2chris22 already run these — cheapest activation available
Early October	Off-Road Expo, Southern California	Your anchor show. Venue moved to OC Fair & Event Center in 2026
Early November	SEMA, Las Vegas	Industry, not consumer. Different objective — dealers and press

The cheapest events are not on this list. Two of your prospects run their own: @poorboyraptor's Arizona Raptor Runs (7th edition) and @zr2chris22's Foos Gone Wheeling group. An ambassador who brings an existing event is worth more than one who attends yours.

Near-term, outside the 2027 frame: @395jnky runs *Overlanding for Warriors*, **13–15 November 2026**, Eastern Sierra, benefiting wounded veterans. Five weeks out. Small account, genuine cause, cheap presence — and it happens before the program formally starts.

Part 5 — The term, and the gap between now and January

Point 2 is a clean structure. Two problems with it as stated.

Problem 1 — the three-month hole. It is October. @22protaco is receptive *now*. @campygilmore is mid-conversation *now*. Telling warm contacts "we'll start in January" loses momentum you will not get back.

Fix: term runs **from signature through 31 December 2027**. Everyone lands on the same renewal date, and early signers get a longer first term — which costs you nothing, because they were going to post anyway, and reads as a founding-member perk.

Problem 2 — reviewing "near the end" is too late. If renewal conversations happen in December 2027, you start 2028 with no roster and a scramble.

Fix, with dates:

When	What
Signature → 31 Dec 2027	Term
+90 days from signature	Checkpoint, not a review. Is the rhythm working, are posts landing, is the code being used? Fix problems while they are small
End Q2 2027	Mid-term review. Expand roster from 8 to 12–15 if the operating rhythm is holding
October 2027	Renewal conversations open — *before* the Off-Road Expo, so the show doubles as the 2028 pitch
30 November 2027	Renewals signed. December is quiet by design
1 January 2028	New term starts with no gap

Part 6 — Discount codes: the mechanics

One unique code per ambassador, in Shopify. Format: their handle or a shortened version. Memorable, obviously theirs.

Without unique codes the program is unmeasurable, and the 2028 renewal decision has nothing to stand on. This is the single most important piece of plumbing in the whole plan.

Set, and write down, before any code is issued:

- **Discount %** — see Part 1A. 10–15% recommended. Not stackable with other promotions.
- **Commission?** If a code also pays the ambassador, this becomes an affiliate relationship: **1099 obligations, a payout process, and a different motivation** than a perk. Recommendation: Tier 1 only, keep Tiers 2 and 3 as a pure perk.
- **Expiry** — align to term end, 31 December 2027. Expiring codes make the renewal conversation concrete.
- **Exclusions** — sale items, clearance, and anything that would push a line below floor.

Watch for: codes leaking onto coupon aggregator sites. It happens to every program. Review redemptions monthly and look for volume that does not match the ambassador's audience size.

Part 7 — How you will know whether this worked

Point 2 commits you to a review at the end of 2027. A review needs something to review, and you cannot retrofit measurement. Decide these now:

Per ambassador, tracked monthly:

- Code redemptions, and revenue through them
- Posts delivered vs committed (12/year)
- Events attended vs offered
- Content assets delivered and usable
- Reach and engagement on Jackman posts specifically, not on their account overall

Program level:

- Cost per ambassador, all in — wheels at COGS, shipping, stipends, fees
- Revenue attributed to codes
- Assets produced, valued against what the equivalent shoot would have cost. **For Tier 1 this is likely the largest return and the easiest to miss**
- Jackman follower growth during the program, against the 760 baseline

One honest expectation. Direct code revenue will probably not cover the cost of the wheels in year one. That is normal, and it is not the point. In year one you are buying **proof** — a content library, a visible roster, and evidence the product exists on real trucks. Judge 2027 on assets and credibility. Judge 2028 on revenue.

Set that expectation internally now, before someone asks in March why the codes have not paid for themselves.

Part 8 — Not in your seven points, and needed

Gap	Why it matters
FTC disclosure	Legal exposure, and currently absent from the plan entirely
Content usage rights	Without it you chase permission post by post for a year
Measurement	The 2028 review has no basis otherwise
Termination and conduct clause	A 12-month tie to an individual with no exit
Dealer channel conflict	Part 1A. The biggest commercial risk in the plan
Fitment availability	**Check before you sign anyone.** If an ambassador's truck has no fitment in your lineup, the deal is dead on arrival and the conversation is embarrassing. Audit the Wave 1 trucks against stock first
Who runs it day to day	Part 1C. Capacity is the binding constraint, not budget
What happens to the wheels at term end	Tier 1 gets a free set. If they do not renew, do they keep them? (Recommendation: yes. Clawback is not worth the ill will, and a set of your wheels on a truck is advertising either way)

Part 9 — Proposed opening roster of 8

From the master sheet, with the conversations already in flight.

Tier 1 — Founding (4)

Who	Why	Status
@22protaco	Receptive now, shoots wheel close-ups unprompted. First signature	In conversation
@yotawolf89	Highest score of 59. Working photographer, San Diego. The install-day plan rests on him	**Not yet contacted**
@ghostpro.la	Only public email on the board. Pro photographer, 2026 Tacoma, LA	**Not yet contacted**
@campygilmore	Anchor of the cluster, and buying a ~10K business — partnership, not placement	In conversation

Tier 2 — Ambassador (4)

Who	Why
@keepitdirty_offroad	SoCal Ford, runs group runs. Covers Ford and brings an event
@groovyrunner.gx	Two rigs, two fitments, one agreement. Orange County
@zr2chris22	Best Chevy above 20K, and owns a wheeling group
@chance.the.raptr	Bronco Raptor — halo platform with almost no wheel competition

Contractor (1, parallel): @familycruiser250 — photography day rate with usage rights, posting included.

Program-design consult (not an ambassador): Ramsi (handle needed) — talk to him **before** terms are fixed. He carries ambassador-program detail from other brands, which is free competitive research on how rivals structure deals. Then make him a founding ambassador cheaply; connectors are worth more than their follower count.

Note the shape: this roster is Tacoma-heavy, because that is where the warm relationships are. @zr2chris22 and @chance.the.raptr are the deliberate correction. Ram, Tundra and GMC remain uncovered and **cannot be solved by recruiting** — nobody covers them above 5,000 followers. That is a separate decision: develop those creators now while they are cheap, or skip those platforms for 2027.

Part 10 — From here to 1 January

Window	What
Now → mid-Oct	Decide: discount %, dealer position, tier economics. Audit fitment against the Wave 1 trucks. Talk to Ramsi
Mid–late Oct	Draft the agreement and the one-page ambassador brief. Contact @ghostpro.la and @yotawolf89 — the two highest-value untouched names
Late Oct → Nov	Close Tier 1. Set up Shopify codes. Book @familycruiser250's shoot. Decide on *Overlanding for Warriors*, 13–15 Nov
Nov → Dec	Ship wheels and install. **This is the install-day content push** — the whole 2027 plan depends on having this library before January
December	Close Tier 2. Build the 2027 event calendar once dates are confirmed
1 Jan 2027	Program live, with assets already in hand

Part 11 — Scorecard: where the program sits today

Rated as described in Part 0, before anything in this document is applied.

6 out of 10

That is a genuinely good score for a first program, and the reason is worth stating plainly: **nothing in your seven points is wrong.** Every instinct is correct. The program is *incomplete*, not misguided — and incomplete is a much easier problem.

Most brands at this stage are mailing free product to whoever asks, with no term, no cadence, no events and no attribution. You have all four.

Dimension	Today	Why
Event program	8	The strongest element. Physical activation at this stage is rare and it is what justifies a SoCal-weighted roster
Term structure	8	Annual with a renewal review is real structure. Needs dates, not a different shape
Deliverables clarity	6	Monthly cadence is clear and realistic. The organic/promo tension needs resolving
Compensation design	6	Right instinct — tiering by value. Not yet systematised, and a cluster that compares notes will expose that
Operational capacity	4	No plan for who runs it. You are one person
Attribution & measurement	4	Codes exist, but nothing defines what gets measured or what the 2028 review judges
Dealer channel coherence	3	An unaddressed conflict with the 25-dealer pipeline
Ambassador retention	3	Purely transactional. Wheels and a code. Nothing here makes anyone *stay*
Growth / compounding	2	No referral loop, no roster community, no ambassador page. The program cannot grow itself
Legal & risk	1	Disclosure, content rights, exclusivity and exit are all absent

Parts 1–10 of this document take it to roughly 8.5. They fix the protective layer — the things that stop the program hurting you.

Parts 12 and 13 are what take it to 9. They are the things that make the program *work*, rather than merely not fail.

I would not claim a 10 is available on paper. The last point is earned in execution — whether you actually answer every ambassador within a day, whether the wheels ship when you said, whether the roster feels like something people are glad to belong to.

Part 12 — The retention layer: why they stay after month three

This is the single biggest gap in the plan. Your seven points give an ambassador free wheels and a discount code. That is a transaction, and transactions have a half-life. Month one they are delighted. Month six they are posting because they agreed to, which shows.

What makes people advocate rather than comply is **status, access and belonging**. All three are nearly free.

Status

- **A real title, limited and numbered.** "Jackman Founding Ambassador, 2027" — and only ever issue twelve of them. Scarcity you create once and never repeat is worth more than discount percentage.
- **A physical artefact.** A numbered plate, a patch, an embroidered jacket. People photograph these unprompted. It costs very little and it shows up in their content without you asking.
- **Public recognition on your channels**, not just theirs. An ambassador introduction post for each one. They will share it, which means you get a post you did not have to ask for.

Access

- **See new products before the public.** Finishes, sizes, the next line. Cheap, and it makes them feel inside the brand rather than hired by it.
- **Real input into product.** Let them vote on a colourway, name a finish, or test a prototype. An ambassador who named a finish will talk about that wheel for years. This is the highest-leverage, lowest-cost item in this entire document.
- **A direct line to you.** Not a form. Your actual phone number.

Belonging

Put the roster in one group chat. This is the unlock, and it is specific to your situation.

Your Wave 1 is seven people who already follow each other inside one SoCal cluster. Right now that is a *hazard* — they will compare deals. Formalise it and the same fact becomes the program's engine: they coordinate builds, tag each other, show up at the same events, and create a visible scene rather than eight unrelated sponsored posts.

It also turns the comparison problem inside out. With published tiers and a shared room, comparing notes **confirms** the structure is fair instead of exposing that it is not.

- One group chat for the roster, with you in it.
- A short monthly note — what shipped, what is coming, who did something worth seeing.
- An annual get-together. A trail day costs almost nothing and it is the thing people remember.

Reciprocity

Periodically give with no ask attached. A cleaning kit, a hat, a set of valve caps in the new finish. No deliverable requested. The cost is trivial and it resets the relationship from obligation to goodwill — which is exactly what you need around month six.

Part 13 — The compounding layer: how the program grows itself

Today the program grows only when Austin does cold outreach. That caps it at whatever one person can sustain. Four changes make it compound.

1. Build the ambassador page on jackmanwheels.com

The highest-value item in this section, and currently absent from the plan entirely.

An `/ambassadors` page with every ambassador, their truck, their build spec and their code does five things at once:

- **Converts.** "Shop Jose's build" is a far better path than a product grid, and conversion is the known problem — 0.16%
- **Ranks.** Their names and build terms are searched. This is real SEO surface you do not currently have
- **Confers status.** It makes the roster real, and gives each ambassador something to link to
- **Earns links.** Every ambassador has a Linktree. Give them a reason to point one at you
- **Recruits.** Prospects see a real program rather than a cold DM

2. Coordinate waves instead of scattering posts

Eight ambassadors posting whenever produces noise. Eight posting inside the same seven days produces a moment — to a largely overlapping SoCal audience, it looks like the whole scene moved at once.

Keep the monthly minimum organic and scattered. Then **four times a year, coordinate a wave** around a launch or a show. Same week, their own voice, their own truck.

3. Build in a referral loop

Each ambassador may nominate one person per year. You keep the final say.

This is already proven in your own pipeline: Ramsi came from a show conversation, and the entire 59-account roster was built by walking Instagram's suggestion graph outward from two people @campygilmore knows. Formalise what is already happening.

4. Make the tiers a ladder, not a label

Publish a promotion path: Tier 2 → Tier 1 on performance, reviewed at the mid-term point.

This fixes the fairness problem directly. "He gets free wheels and I don't" is corrosive. "He's Tier 1, here is how you get there" is motivating. It also gives you a lever that costs nothing to offer and is genuinely valued.

Part 14 — Three protections specific to Jackman

Not generic program hygiene. These come from your own guardrails.

1. Wheel-category exclusivity for the term. Currently unaddressed, and it is the main thing you are actually buying. Without it, an ambassador can run a competitor next month and your free set becomes a gift. Standard terms: exclusive in wheels only — tires, lighting and suspension stay open, which is what makes it easy to agree to, since most of the roster is already with Nitto or KC.

2. A scripted answer for fitment questions. Playbook rule 9: *fitment questions get "confirm with your dealer," never a spec from memory, in any comment, on any platform.*

Your ambassadors **will** be asked fitment questions in their comments, constantly, and they will answer helpfully and wrongly. Give them the script at onboarding and a channel to escalate to. This is a returns-and-liability issue wearing the costume of a social media question.

3. Content guardrails without dictating copy. Not a caption to read out. A short shot list: wheels visible and clean, no competitor product in frame on Jackman posts, real installs only, no rendered wheels presented as photography (rule 6), and a reminder that there are no load-rating or strength claims to repeat (rule 2) — because an ambassador repeating a claim you never made is still your problem.

Open questions

1. **Wheel COGS, retail, and the "deep discount" percentage.** Needed to model tier cost at 8, 12 and 15 ambassadors.
2. **Dealer position on codes** (Part 1A) — the decision that gates everything else in point 7.
3. **Commission or pure perk?** Changes this from a sponsorship to an affiliate program, with tax paperwork attached.
4. **Event budget per show** — stipend, passes, insurance.
5. **Ramsi's handle.**
6. **What business is @campygilmore buying?** If it sells parts, he is a dealer conversation as well as an ambassador one.
7. **What did @familycruiser250 actually ask for?** A day rate and an influencer fee are different numbers and need different answers.
8. **Ram / Tundra / GMC — develop or skip?** Deliberately, not by drift.
9. **Does the monthly post have to be Instagram?** Several of the best prospects are YouTube-first — their Instagram is a trailer for the channel. Recommendation: "one

piece of content per month on their primary channel," which is worth more from a YouTuber and costs you nothing to allow.

10. **Is there a budget envelope for 2027?** "Review each one individually" is unbounded without a ceiling. A number, even a rough one, turns every individual negotiation into a simple yes or no.
11. **Will you offer wheel-category exclusivity both ways?** They go exclusive to you in wheels — do you agree not to sign a direct rival within their niche or region? Worth deciding before someone asks.

The ambassador-facing one-pager, the agreement, and the outreach messages are the next artefacts. Those are external copy and go through `jackman-brand-guidelines` and the `humanizer` pass before they ship. This document is internal and has not.